



THE HOUSING INFO STYLE GUIDES

The Sage French Rustic Style Guide

The details that make the look, and how to recreate it.

WELCOME

A home that feels sun-washed, not staged

Soft sage cabinetry, warm cream plaster, honey oak and the gentle glow of aged brass. Sage French Rustic is the look of a farmhouse in the south of France that has been lived in for generations, where nothing is precious and everything feels loved.

It looks relaxed, but it is not random. Every room follows the same few rules: warm undertones, natural materials, woven texture and collected details. This guide breaks those rules down into paint colors, finishes and simple formulas you can follow room by room.

Use it in order the first time, then come back to the checklists whenever you are ready to tackle the next space.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Start with the palette and finishes, since they tie every room together. Then add architecture and lighting, and finish with furniture, fabric and styling. Always sample paint on your own walls before committing.

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THE LOOK

The French Rustic formula

Six ingredients show up in every room. Get these right and the rest falls into place.

01

Sun-washed cream walls

Warm creams with a soft yellow undertone and a chalky, plaster-like finish. Never stark or grey white.

02

Soft sage cabinetry

A muted, earthy sage on kitchen cabinets, islands and built-ins. It reads calm and timeless, not trendy.

03

Natural oak & weathered wood

Honey oak floors, farmhouse tables and open shelves with honest grain and a little wear.

04

Woven texture

Rattan, rush, seagrass and jute in stools, baskets, shades and pendants add softness and warmth.

05

Aged brass & honed stone

Unlacquered brass hardware and lighting next to honed limestone, marble and creamy zellige tile.

06

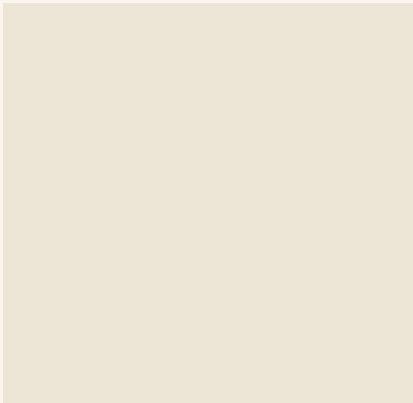
Collected, lived-in details

Ceramic crocks, olive branches, botanical prints and faded floral runners make it feel gathered over time.

INSIDE THE GUIDE

The color palette

Six colors and finishes do all the work: a sun-washed cream, soft sage, linen beige, a touch of terracotta, natural oak and aged brass.



WALLS

Swiss Coffee

Benjamin Moore OC-45

A soft, sun-washed cream. The backdrop for every room, trim and ceiling.

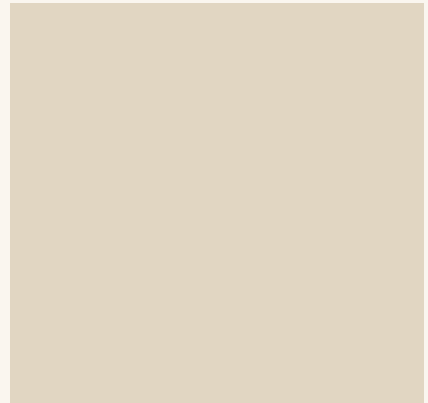


CABINETS

Clary Sage

Sherwin-Williams SW 6178

A muted, earthy sage for kitchen cabinets, built-ins and a vanity.



UPHOLSTERY

Joa's White

Farrow & Ball No. 226

The warm linen beige to match sofas, curtains and bedding to.



ACCENT

Red Earth

Farrow & Ball No. 64

A soft terracotta for pots, a powder room or a painted chair.



WOOD

Natural Oak

Minwax Wood Finish 209

A light, warm oak for tables, beams, shelves and floors.



METAL

Aged Brass

Unlacquered finish

For lighting, hardware and faucets. It deepens beautifully with time.

Colors shown are printed or on-screen previews and will vary by device. Always test real samples on your walls in morning and evening light before you paint.

THE PALETTE

Where each color goes

Sage French Rustic works because every cream, sage and oak shares the same warm undertone. Let cream do most of the work and keep sage to the cabinetry, so the room feels soft rather than green.

SURFACE	COLOR	SHEEN	NOTES
Walls	Swiss Coffee, BM OC-45	Matte or limewash	For a plaster look, limewash a feature wall in a similar cream.
Trim & doors	Swiss Coffee, BM OC-45	Satin	Same color as the walls, one sheen up, so trim reads soft, not stark.
Ceilings	Swiss Coffee, BM OC-45	Flat	Pair with natural oak beams for instant farmhouse character.
Kitchen cabinetry	Clary Sage, SW 6178	Satin	Perimeter, island or both. Pair with brass and honed stone.
Built-ins & vanity	Clary Sage, SW 6178	Satin	An entry bench, a banquette, shelving or a bath vanity.
Accent moments	Red Earth, F&B 64	Matte	Use sparingly: terracotta pots, a powder room, a painted chair.
Upholstery	Joa's White, F&B 226	Fabric	Match linen slipcovers, curtains and bedding to this tone.

ALSO TRY, WARM CREAMS

Farrow & Ball Lime White No. 1 · Benjamin Moore White Dove OC-17 · Sherwin-Williams Alabaster SW 7008 · Benjamin Moore Navajo White OC-95

ALSO TRY, SOFT SAGES

Benjamin Moore Saybrook Sage HC-114 · Farrow & Ball Lichen No. 19 · Benjamin Moore October Mist 1495 · Farrow & Ball Vert de Terre No. 234

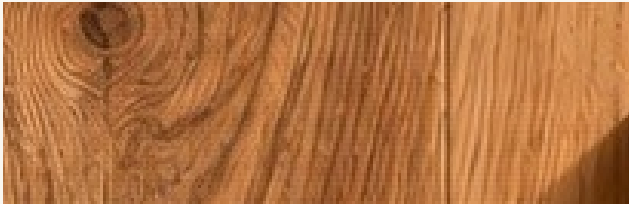
DESIGNER TIP

Sage shifts more than any other color. North-facing rooms pull it grey, so lean warmer and yellower there. South-facing rooms can take a slightly cooler sage. Test large samples on two walls and check them at 9am and 7pm.

MATERIALS

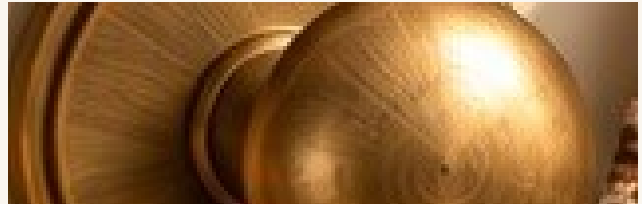
Wood, metal & stone

Natural materials that soften with age are exactly what make French rustic rooms feel lived-in.



Wood: natural oak

- ◆ Honey or natural oak for floors, farmhouse tables, open shelves and benches.
- ◆ Mix in one or two weathered or reclaimed pieces with real wear in every room.
- ◆ Keep finishes matte or oiled. Skip shiny polyurethane.



Metal: aged brass

- ◆ Unlacquered or antique brass for lighting, cup pulls, latches and faucets.
- ◆ Stick to one warm metal family per room; aged bronze and iron work as accents.
- ◆ Avoid chrome, polished nickel and matte black, which read cool and modern.



Stone & tile: limestone & zellige

- ◆ Honed limestone, travertine or soft marble for counters and fireplace surrounds.
- ◆ Creamy handmade zellige or square tile for backsplashes, run up to the ceiling.
- ◆ Choose honed and handmade over polished and perfect.



Fabric: linen, cotton & woven

- ◆ Washed linen for slipcovers, curtains and bedding in cream and oatmeal.
- ◆ Small florals, ticking stripes and sage checks on pillows and cushions.
- ◆ Rattan, rush and seagrass in stools, baskets, shades and pendants.

ARCHITECTURE GUIDE

Adding character to a plain room

Texture and old-house bones are what make these rooms feel like a French farmhouse. Here is how to add them, even to a builder-grade home. Costs below are rough ranges and vary by region and home.

01

Limewash or plaster walls

A chalky limewash or clay plaster gives flat drywall the soft movement of an old stone farmhouse. Apply in overlapping cross strokes.

DIY: \$80 to \$250 per room · **Pro:** \$4 to \$12 per sq ft
Beginner friendly; practice on a board first.

02

Ceiling beams

Stained oak or reclaimed beams bring instant age. Space them 3 to 5 feet apart and run them across the shorter length of the room.

Faux beams: \$20 to \$50 per linear ft · **Reclaimed, installed:** \$60 to \$150 per linear ft
Lightweight faux beams install on a mounting block.

03

Arched doorways

Round the top of an existing cased opening with an arch kit, or reframe a doorway with a plastered arch between two rooms.

Arch kit: \$150 to \$600 · **Pro reframe:** \$1,500 to \$4,000
Check for load-bearing walls with a contractor first.

04

Open oak shelving

Swap one run of upper cabinets for thick oak shelves on brass or wood brackets. Aim for 10 to 12 inches deep and 1 1/2 to 2 inches thick.

DIY: \$100 to \$300 per shelf · **Pro:** \$300 to \$800
Anchor into studs; dishes are heavier than they look.

WHERE TO START

If you only do one thing, swap one wall of upper cabinets for two oak shelves, or limewash the wall behind your sofa or bed. Both are affordable, visible and change the whole feel of the room.

ARCHITECTURE GUIDE

Details that finish the shell

Once the big moves are done, these smaller upgrades carry the look into every corner.

- ◆ **Wide-plank oak floors.** Aim for 7 to 10 inch planks in a matte, natural or honey finish. Narrow glossy strips read new.
- ◆ **Taller baseboards.** 5 to 7 inches with a simple profile, painted the trim color.
- ◆ **Wainscot or beadboard.** About one third of the wall height, 32 to 36 inches in kitchens and baths, in cream or sage.
- ◆ **Zellige backsplash.** Creamy handmade tile run all the way to the ceiling behind the range.
- ◆ **A plaster range hood.** A plastered or painted hood with an oak ledge becomes the kitchen's focal point.
- ◆ **Brass hardware.** Unlacquered cup pulls, latches and knobs tie the cabinetry to the lighting.

DESIGNER TIP

Keep trim and doors cream throughout the home and let the cabinetry carry the sage. Paint trim sage only in a room you are color drenching.



LIGHTING FORMULA

Warm, woven and golden

Brass domes, woven pendants and linen-shade sconces do the heavy lifting. Aim for at least three sources of light in every room, and keep most of them at eye level or below.

2700K

BULB COLOR TEMPERATURE

90+

CRI FOR TRUE COLORS

3+

LIGHT SOURCES PER ROOM

FIXTURE	HOW BIG	HOW HIGH
Dining chandelier	About half the table's width; linear fixtures about two thirds its length	30 to 34 inches above the tabletop
Room chandelier	Room length + width in feet = diameter in inches	At least 7 ft clear of the floor
Island pendants	14 to 20 inches each; 2 or 3 over the island	30 to 36 inches above the counter
Woven pendants	Go a little bigger; rattan reads lighter than metal	30 to 36 inches above a table or counter
Wall sconces	Scaled to the mirror, shelf or art they flank	60 to 66 inches from the floor to center
Table lamps	Shade bottom near eye level when seated	Pair on consoles and nightstands

CHOOSE

Aged brass domes, rattan or seagrass shades, linen-shade sconces, and ceramic or stone lamp bases.

PUT EVERYTHING ON DIMMERS

Dimmed, warm light at night is what gives these rooms their golden glow. Choose dimmable LED bulbs.

FURNITURE & FABRICS

Relaxed, never precious

The mix is what keeps it fresh: soft slipcovers, honest wood, woven seats and natural fabric.



- ◆ **Sofas:** slipcovered linen in cream or oatmeal with loose cushions. Relaxed, never stiff or tufted.
- ◆ **Accent chairs:** one pair in rattan, rush or a sage linen, or a single vintage find.
- ◆ **Wood:** oak farmhouse and trestle tables, pine chests and rush-seat chairs with honest wear.
- ◆ **The 1 in 3 rule:** at least one of every three pieces should be vintage, antique or handmade.
- ◆ **Fabrics:** washed linen, cotton, ticking stripe and small florals. Pattern comes from rugs, pillows and runners.
- ◆ **Scale:** leave 18 inches between a sofa and coffee table, and 30 to 36 inches for walkways.

IMPERFECTION IS THE SECRET

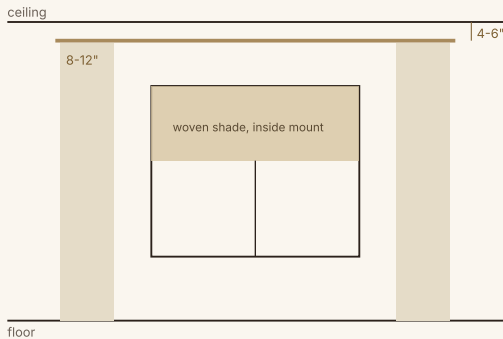
A worn table edge, a crazed crock, a slightly rumpled slipcover. Let things look used and loved.

RUGS, WINDOWS & DRAPERY

Soft, layered and filtered

French rustic rooms glow because light is filtered, not blocked. These simple numbers make ceilings look taller and rooms feel finished.

Window & drapery rules



- ◆ Mount the rod 4 to 6 inches below the ceiling, or halfway between the window top and ceiling.
- ◆ Extend the rod 8 to 12 inches past the frame on each side.
- ◆ Layer a woven bamboo shade inside the frame with linen panels outside it.
- ◆ Fabric width 2 to 2.5 times the window width; let panels kiss the floor.
- ◆ Unlined or lightly lined linen in cream or oatmeal, on a brass or wood rod.

Rug rules

ROOM	RULE OF THUMB
Living	Jute or sisal base layered with a faded floral or Oushak. All front legs on it.
Dining	Flatweave or jute 24 to 30 inches beyond the table on all sides.
Bedroom	18 to 24 inches showing on each side of the bed.
Entry & hall	A runner with 4 to 6 inches of floor showing on each side.
Kitchen	A faded floral runner in front of the sink or range.

LOOK FOR

Faded florals, Oushak and vintage-style rugs in sage, rust, gold and cream, layered over jute or seagrass. Go bigger than feels natural.



ROOM 01 · THE ENTRY

A soft welcome

A cream plaster arch, a sage-green bench with brass hooks and woven baskets, and a vintage floral runner on oak floors. A brass lantern and a potted olive tree make the entry feel like a country house, not a hallway.

THE FORMULA

01 Build in a bench

A sage bench with cubbies or baskets below and a row of brass hooks above gives coats, bags and shoes a beautiful home.

02 Hang a pendant

An aged brass pendant overhead sets the tone. Add a lamp or sconce at eye level so the entry glows at night.

03 Ground it with a runner

A vintage floral runner leaving 4 to 6 inches of floor on each side instantly makes a hallway feel finished.

04 Bring in something living

A potted olive tree or a crock of olive branches softens the plaster and makes the space feel lived-in.

DESIGNER TIP

Use sage green on built-ins and keep the surrounding walls a warm cream. This creates gentle contrast and gives the room more depth without overwhelming the space.

SKIP THIS

A bare wall and a tiny mat. Go big on storage, the runner and greenery; they do the most work in the smallest space.

CHECKLIST

☐ Walls and trim Swiss Coffee☐ Plaster arch or arched opening☐ Sage bench in Clary Sage☐ Brass hooks and woven baskets☐ Aged brass pendant☐ Floral runner and olive tree

SHOP THE LOOK · LINKS ON PAGE 19

Darlana lantern · Phipps woven bench · Reta arched mirror · Vintage Blossoms runner · white ceramic pitcher



ROOM 02 · THE LIVING ROOM

A place to linger

A limestone fireplace as the anchor, a slipcovered linen sofa, a sage velvet armchair and a chunky oak coffee table. A jute rug layered with a vintage rug and linen roman shades keep it warm and relaxed.

THE FORMULA

01 Anchor to the fireplace

Face the sofa toward it and add a sage armchair to close the circle, keeping seating within 8 to 10 feet.

02 Balance cream and wood

Keep upholstery cream, add one chunky oak piece to every seating group, and bring in sage through a chair or pillows.

03 Light in three layers

Brass sconces flanking shelves or the mantel, ceramic table lamps at seated eye level, and one floor lamp.

04 Collect the details

A crock of olive branches, a stack of books and a wooden bowl. A few meaningful objects, not many small ones.

DESIGNER TIP

Layer a smaller vintage rug over a large jute one. It adds pattern and history without the cost of one big antique rug.

SKIP THIS

A tight, tufted sofa in a cool fabric. French rustic seating should look like it invites you to curl up.

CHECKLIST

☐ Slipcovered linen sofa☐ Sage velvet armchair☐ Jute base plus vintage rug☐ Chunky oak coffee table☐ Limestone or plaster fireplace☐ Linen roman shades

SHOP THE LOOK · LINKS ON PAGE 19

Wilhelmina slipcover sofa · Lockwood coffee table · Tess ceramic lamp · Billie rug · Rue bamboo shade



ROOM 03 · THE DINING ROOM

Made for gathering

A rustic oak farmhouse table, rush-seat chairs and a sage banquette tucked under the window, with brass dome pendants overhead. Easy enough for every day, lovely enough for long dinners.

THE FORMULA

01 Go long and wooden

A rectangular oak farmhouse table reads rustic. Leave 36 to 42 inches behind each chair to pull out and walk by.

02 Space the pendants

Hang brass domes 30 to 34 inches above the table, spaced so each sits roughly over a third of its length.

03 Tuck in a banquette

A built-in sage banquette under the window with linen cushions seats more people and softens the room.

04 Dress the table simply

A linen runner, ironstone and a low crock of greenery you can talk over. Keep centerpieces under 12 inches tall.

DESIGNER TIP

Hang pendants 30 to 34 inches above the table and space them so each sits roughly over a third of the table.

SKIP THIS

A matched dining set. Mix rush chairs with a banquette or bench so the room looks gathered over time.

CHECKLIST

☐ Oak farmhouse table☐ Rush-seat dining chairs☐ Two or three brass domes☐ Sage banquette with cushions☐ Jute rug under the table☐ Linen runner and ironstone

SHOP THE LOOK · LINKS ON PAGE 19

Farmhouse trestle table · Leola chair · Butte dome pendant · Billie rug · white ceramic pitcher



ROOM 04 · THE KITCHEN

The heart of the home

Soft sage cabinetry with creamy trim, honed stone counters, oak beams and open shelving give the kitchen its architectural character. Brass hardware and pendants warm it all up.

THE FORMULA

01 Sage below, cream above

Paint the cabinetry Clary Sage and keep walls, hood and backsplash cream so the room stays light and soft.

02 One warm metal

Keep the faucet, pulls and pendants in the same brass family. Unlacquered brass will patina and look better every year.

03 Add oak and open shelves

Natural oak beams and a run of open shelves styled with ceramics and cutting boards add age and warmth.

04 Soften the hard surfaces

A floral runner, linen towels, rush stools and a bowl of lemons or pears warm all that stone and tile.

DESIGNER TIP

Choose a sage with a warm, grey-green undertone. Check it next to your floor and counters in daylight before committing.

SKIP THIS

Glossy subway tile and chrome fixtures. Choose handmade zellige and aged brass so the room glows instead of glares.

CHECKLIST

☐ Clary Sage cabinetry☐ Honed stone counters☐ Oak beams and open shelves☐ Two or three brass pendants☐ Brass faucet and cup pulls☐ Rush stools and a floral runner

SHOP THE LOOK · LINKS ON PAGE 19

Butte dome pendant · Mari pendant · Eloise woven stool · Brunswick cup pull · Connor bridge faucet



ROOM 05 · THE BEDROOM

A sanctuary to come home to

A linen bed with crisp white and sage bedding, a small-floral quilt, oak nightstands with linen-shaded lamps and a rush bench at the foot. Calm, sunlit and quietly collected.

THE FORMULA

01 Symmetry calms

Matching oak nightstands with a pair of linen-shaded lamps, and art centered over the bed, make the room feel restful.

02 Layer the bedding

Crisp white sheets, a sage coverlet and a small-floral quilt folded at the foot. Finish with euro shams and one lumbar.

03 Filter the light

Linen roman shades or panels hung high and wide soften morning light and make the ceiling feel taller.

04 Keep the palette quiet

Cream, white and sage with one small print. Let the rug and quilt carry all the pattern.

DESIGNER TIP

Mix only two or three tones in your bedding: white, sage and one small print. It keeps the bed layered without looking busy.

SKIP THIS

Too many patterns at once. One small floral is charming; three competing prints feel busy.

CHECKLIST

☐ Linen upholstered bed☐ White and sage bedding☐ Small-floral quilt☐ Oak nightstands and lamps☐ Rush bench at the foot☐ Botanical art above the bed

SHOP THE LOOK · LINKS ON PAGE 19

Selby bed · Phipps woven bench · Berkshire sconce · Belgian flax curtain · woodblocked botanical

ROOM 06 · THE BATH

A moment to yourself

A furniture-style sage vanity with a honed stone top, brass sconces beside an arched mirror, cream zellige and a freestanding tub carry the rest of the home's warmth into the bathroom.

THE FORMULA

01 Treat the vanity like furniture

A sage vanity on legs or a plinth with a honed stone top feels custom and brings color to a hard room.

02 Light for your face

Brass sconces on either side of the mirror at about 66 inches give even, flattering light.

03 Use handmade tile

Cream zellige behind the vanity or in the shower catches light like old plaster.

04 Warm it up

A floral runner, cream towels, a potted olive tree and a woven basket keep it from feeling clinical.

DESIGNER TIP

Mount sconces on either side of the mirror at about eye level, roughly 66 inches, for the most flattering light.

SKIP THIS

Stark white tile and cool lighting. Choose warm creams, honed stone and 2700K bulbs so the room glows instead of glares.

CHECKLIST

☐ Sage furniture-style vanity

☐ Honed stone top

☐ Arched mirror

☐ Brass sconces at 66 inches

☐ Cream zellige tile

☐ Freestanding tub and runner

SHOP THE LOOK · LINKS ON PAGE 19

Reta arched mirror · Berkshire sconce · Vintage Blossoms runner · Brunswick cup pull · white ceramic pitcher

CURATED SHOPPING

Where to shop the look

Mix a few investment pieces with vintage finds and affordable basics. These are the go-to sources for each category, from splurge to save.

CATEGORY	SPLURGE	MID-RANGE	SAVE & VINTAGE
Lighting	Visual Comfort, Urban Electric	Rejuvenation, McGee & Co.	Schoolhouse, Etsy vintage, Chairish
Rugs	Lawrence of La Brea, Amber Interiors	Loloi (Amber Lewis), Lulu and Georgia	Revival Rugs, Etsy Oushaks
Upholstery	Jenni Kayne, Serena & Lily	McGee & Co., Pottery Barn	Target Studio McGee, Article
Wood & antiques	1stDibs, local antique dealers	McGee & Co., Chairish	Estate sales, thrift and Marketplace
Art & frames	Galleries, original oils	McGee & Co., Juniper Print Shop	Etsy vintage prints, Framebridge
Hardware	Waterworks, Perrin & Rowe	Rejuvenation, Schoolhouse	Plank Hardware, Historic Houseparts
Drapery & shades	The Shade Store, custom workrooms	Pottery Barn, Serena & Lily	Quince linen, Hearth & Hand
Paint	Farrow & Ball, Portola Paints	Benjamin Moore, Sherwin-Williams	Color-matched samples at your local store

SEARCH TERMS THAT WORK

"vintage floral runner" · "rush seat counter stool" ·
 "rattan dome pendant" · "unlacquered brass cup pull"
 · "antique ironstone pitcher" · "vintage botanical print"
 · "French farmhouse oak table"

VINTAGE SHOPPING TIP

Look for honest wear. A scarred oak table or a crazed crock adds the age new pieces cannot fake, and they usually cost less too.

THE SHOPPING LIST

Shop the rooms

Every piece below was chosen to recreate the rooms in this guide, from trusted retailers like Rejuvenation, McGee & Co., Pottery Barn, Visual Comfort and Loloi.

LIGHTING

Butte 18" Dome Pendant, Aged Brass Rejuvenation	Kitchen island	\$449–\$529	SHOP rejuvenation.com
Mari Pendant McGee & Co.	Kitchen island (woven)	\$599–\$999	SHOP mcgeeandco.com
Rigby Linear Chandelier McGee & Co.	Dining room	\$1,999	SHOP mcgeeandco.com
Darlana Medium Lantern Visual Comfort	Entry	\$749–\$1,399	SHOP visualcomfort.com
Berkshire Sconce with Linen Shade Rejuvenation	Bath & bedroom	\$299	SHOP rejuvenation.com
Cabinet Maker's Picture Light Rejuvenation	Study & living room	\$399–\$799	SHOP rejuvenation.com
Tess Ceramic Table Lamp McGee & Co.	Living room	\$376	SHOP mcgeeandco.com
Townes Floor Lamp McGee & Co.	Living room & study	\$838	SHOP mcgeeandco.com

FURNITURE

Wilhelmina Classic Slipcover Sofa McGee & Co.	Living room	From \$4,488	SHOP mcgeeandco.com
Rialto Rattan Barrel Back Chair Threshold x Studio McGee, Target	Living room	\$340	SHOP target.com
Lockwood Coffee Table McGee & Co.	Living room	\$1,795–\$2,155	SHOP mcgeeandco.com

THE SHOPPING LIST · CONTINUED

Shop the rooms

Furniture, rugs, curtains, art and the finishing hardware that pull every room together.

FURNITURE

Cumberland Console McGee & Co.	Entry	\$2,352	SHOP mcgeeandco.com
Farmhouse Trestle Extending Dining Table Pottery Barn	Dining room	\$2,199	SHOP potterybarn.com
Leola Dining Chair McGee & Co.	Dining room	\$699	SHOP mcgeeandco.com
Eloise Woven Counter Stool McGee & Co.	Kitchen island	\$698	SHOP mcgeeandco.com
Selby Bed McGee & Co.	Bedroom	\$4,596	SHOP mcgeeandco.com
Phipps Woven Bench McGee & Co.	Entry & bedroom	\$1,360	SHOP mcgeeandco.com

RUGS & TEXTILES

Billie BIL-03 Rug, Clay / Sage Amber Lewis x Loloi	Living & dining	See site	SHOP loloirugs.com
Vintage Blossoms Hooked Rug, Sage Rifle Paper Co.	Kitchen, entry & bath	From \$269	SHOP riflepaperco.com
Belgian Flax Linen Curtain Pottery Barn	Every room	See site	SHOP potterybarn.com
Rue Bamboo Light Filtering Shade Pottery Barn	Kitchen & living room	\$409–\$699	SHOP potterybarn.com

DECOR & HARDWARE

White Ceramic Pitcher McGee & Co.	Kitchen & dining	\$48	SHOP mcgeeandco.com
Woodblocked Botanical, framed art McGee & Co.	Every room	\$512–\$1,298	SHOP mcgeeandco.com
Brunswick Cup Pull Schoolhouse	Kitchen & bath cabinets	\$29	SHOP schoolhouse.com
Connor Wall Mount Bridge Faucet Rejuvenation	Kitchen	\$1,459–\$2,219	SHOP rejuvenation.com
Reta Arched Wall Mirror McGee & Co.	Entry & bath	\$800	SHOP mcgeeandco.com

Prices and availability were checked in October 2026 and may change. Every item is a designer pick chosen to complete the look. Tap any item name or Shop to open it.

WHY YOU CAN'T JUST COPY A PHOTO

Mistakes to avoid

Saving inspiration is easy. Getting it to look right in your own home is the hard part. These are the most common places it goes wrong.

01

Choosing a cold sage

Sage with a grey or blue undertone turns chilly on the wall. Pick a warm, earthy sage and sample it first.

02

Too much green

Sage is the accent, not the base. Keep it to cabinetry or one built-in and let cream do most of the work.

03

Going themed

One too many roosters and it tips into costume. Keep accessories edited and let materials carry the look.

04

Glossy everything

Shiny tile, polished stone and high-gloss paint fight the soft look. Choose honed, matte and handmade.

05

Skipping texture

An all-smooth room feels flat. Add rattan, rush, linen, jute and wood grain in every space.

06

Cool or mixed metals

Chrome and matte black read modern and cold. Stick with aged brass and a little iron.

07

Getting scale wrong

Small rugs, short curtains and tiny pendants make a room feel unfinished. Follow the numbers in this guide.

08

Relying on overheads

A single ceiling light flattens everything. Add lamps, sconces and under-shelf light on dimmers.

KEEP THIS HANDY

The cheat sheet

Every number in one place. Screenshot it, print it or save it to your phone before you shop.

COLOR & FINISH

Walls & trim	Swiss Coffee BM OC-45
Cabinetry	Clary Sage SW 6178
Upholstery tone	Joa's White F&B 226
Accent	Red Earth F&B 64
Wood stain	Natural Oak Minwax 209
Metal	Aged brass, unlacquered

LIGHTING

Bulbs	2700K, CRI 90+, dimmable
Dining light	30 to 34" above table
Island pendants	30 to 36" above counter
Sconces	60 to 66" to center

WINDOWS & RUGS

Curtain rod	4 to 6" below ceiling
Rod overhang	8 to 12" each side
Panel fullness	2 to 2.5x window width
Shades	Woven, inside mount
Living rug	All front legs on it
Dining rug	24 to 30" past the table
Bedroom rug	18 to 24" each side

ART & ARCHITECTURE

Art over furniture	About 2/3 its width
Art above headboard	8 to 10"
Baseboards	5 to 7" tall
Open shelves	10 to 12" deep
Beams	3 to 5 ft apart



THANK YOU

Bring the look home

Start with the palette, add a little texture and old-house character, layer your lighting and collect slowly. Your home does not need to be finished in a weekend to feel beautiful.

Want a designer's eye on your own rooms? Housing Info offers virtual design packages with a custom plan, shopping links and visual mockups. Send us a message on Instagram to get started.

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